Users care about speed

"Amazon found every 100ms of latency cost them 1% in sales"

"Google found an extra .5 seconds in search page generation time dropped traffic by 20%"

✓ A fast interface feels responsive and trustworthy

✓ Latency affects conversion, engagement, and accessibility

Three different engineering goals

Performance

How quickly does one request complete?

Scalability

How well does performance hold as load increases?

Reliability

How does the service behave when something fails?